

Stop Saying Half of 2026 US Datacenter Capacity Is Canceled

Don't Believe The Vibecoded Estimates, Go Through Every Individual Filing Instead

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JUN 18, 2026 · PAID有償



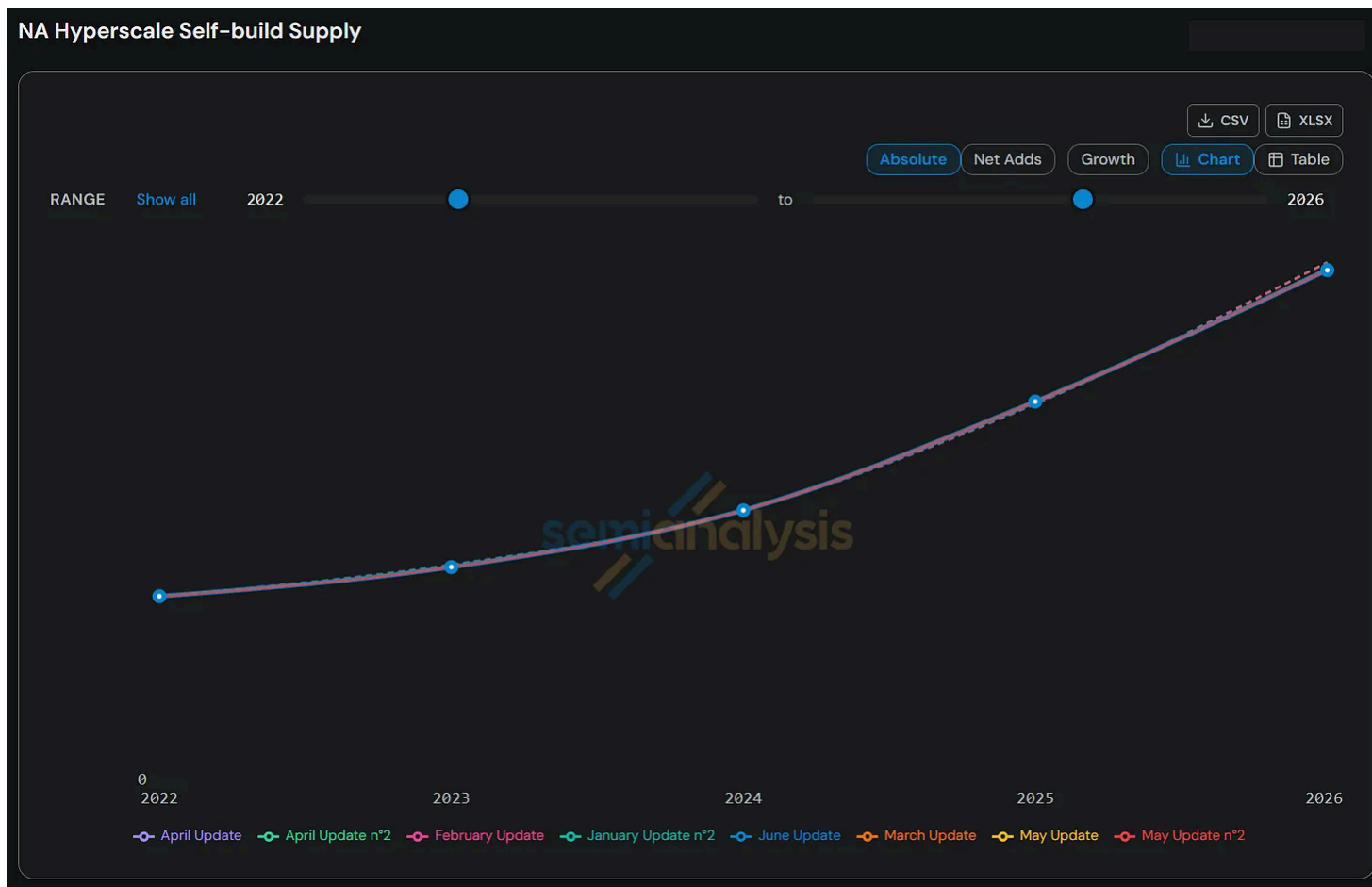
The claim that half of 2026 US datacenter capacity will be delayed or canceled has been circulating widely across financial and social media. This traces back to Bloomberg's April 1, 2026 [piece](#), *America's AI Build-Out Hinges on Chinese Electrical Parts*, which framed the 2026 capacity slowdown as a consequence of a fragile, China-dependent equipment supply chain. Bloomberg didn't lead with that framing, but within days, TechRadar, Tom's Hardware, The Register, and other news outlets ran sharper, more clickbait versions claiming half of datacenters are cancelled, and that's the version now circulating.

We find these claims quite amusing. We've consistently been first to call-out high-profile delays, like Core Scientific ahead of Coreweave's Q3'25 earnings in our industry leading [datacenter tracking model](#). We update the dataset by reviewing every site dozens of times a year. However, over the last 6 months, our YE2026 NA Hyperscaler

Self-build forecast only moved by ~1%, and NA colocation <5%. What is causing the discrepancy?



Source: SemiAnalysis Datacenter Industry Model; Revisions from the past 6 months

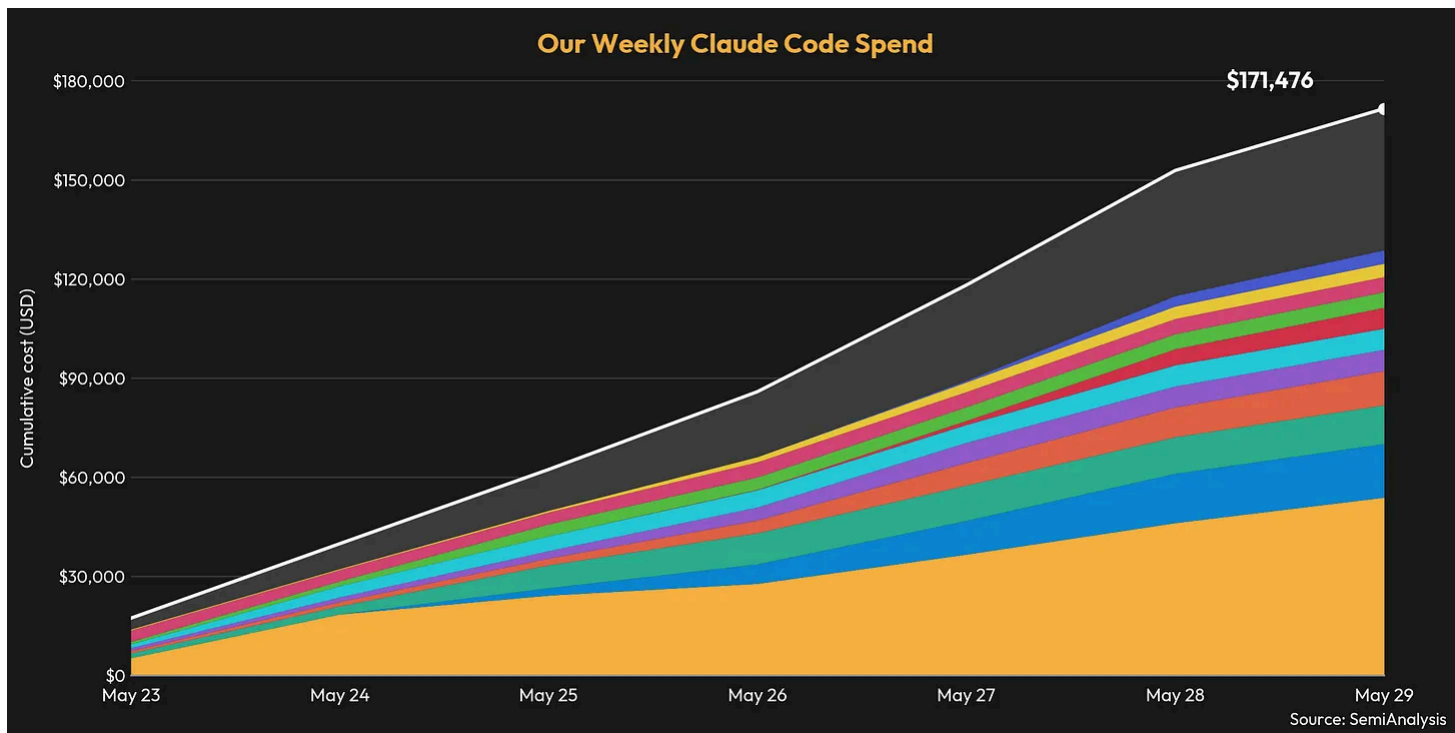


Source: *SemiAnalysis Datacenter Industry Model*; Revisions from the past 6 months

In our view, the culprit is obvious: the data sources behind these claims of “50% of 2026 datacenters are delayed” are essentially uninformed vibe-coded datacenter forecasts that take announcements at face value, without any bit of critical judgement. We’ve seen more and more [Claude Coded](#) datacenter models and estimates crop up, all

of them **wrong**. Thankfully, that's not how we built our model, which is trusted for billion-dollar investment decisions by all the world's largest tech companies in the world, as well as energy and industrials giants, and all the largest investors on Wall Street.

Claude Code pulls press releases, views unfounded GW-scale announcements as ground truth, misunderstands construction timelines and grid complexities, and compiles a terribly inaccurate report. As resident Claude Code users spending **\$170K+ in just one week**, we are very familiar with how to use Claude, and the mistakes others are actively publishing.



Let's be clear, delays and cancellations are occurring. Our Datacenter Model flagged the STACK Infrastructure / Oracle permitting impasse months before Bloom Energy stepped in. We caught the Nebius New Jersey delays, which are still persistent. We nailed the Core Scientific datacenter delays ahead of Coreweave's Q3 earnings. However, we then successfully predicted Coreweave's 1.7GW of Active Power by end of 2026 (exactly the Company's guide) as we determined that other datacenters were on time (no, not everything is delayed!). Our data also predicted ~35B of RPO to be signed by Q1 2026 via our industry-first method to forecast RPO based on datacenter signals.

And most recently, we've determined **STACK Infrastructure/Oracle's site has now been delayed to 2029**, due to a lack of gas pipeline and the ensuing burdensome regulation. We've flagged many many others, some of which have materialized, but many others which aren't realized yet and the market is still misunderstanding. [Check our Datacenter Model for full information.](#)

March 25, 2026

Datacenter Delays Abound: STACK/Oracle, REDACTED, REDACTED, and REDACTED

2 minutes

By Reyk Knuhtsen, Jeremie Eliahou Ontiveros and Maya Barkin



Source: SemiAnalysis Datacenter Industry Model, SemiAnalysis Energy Model

May 28, 2026

Oracle's New Mexico Stargate Gas Pipeline Delayed: No Bloom Without Gas

8 minutes

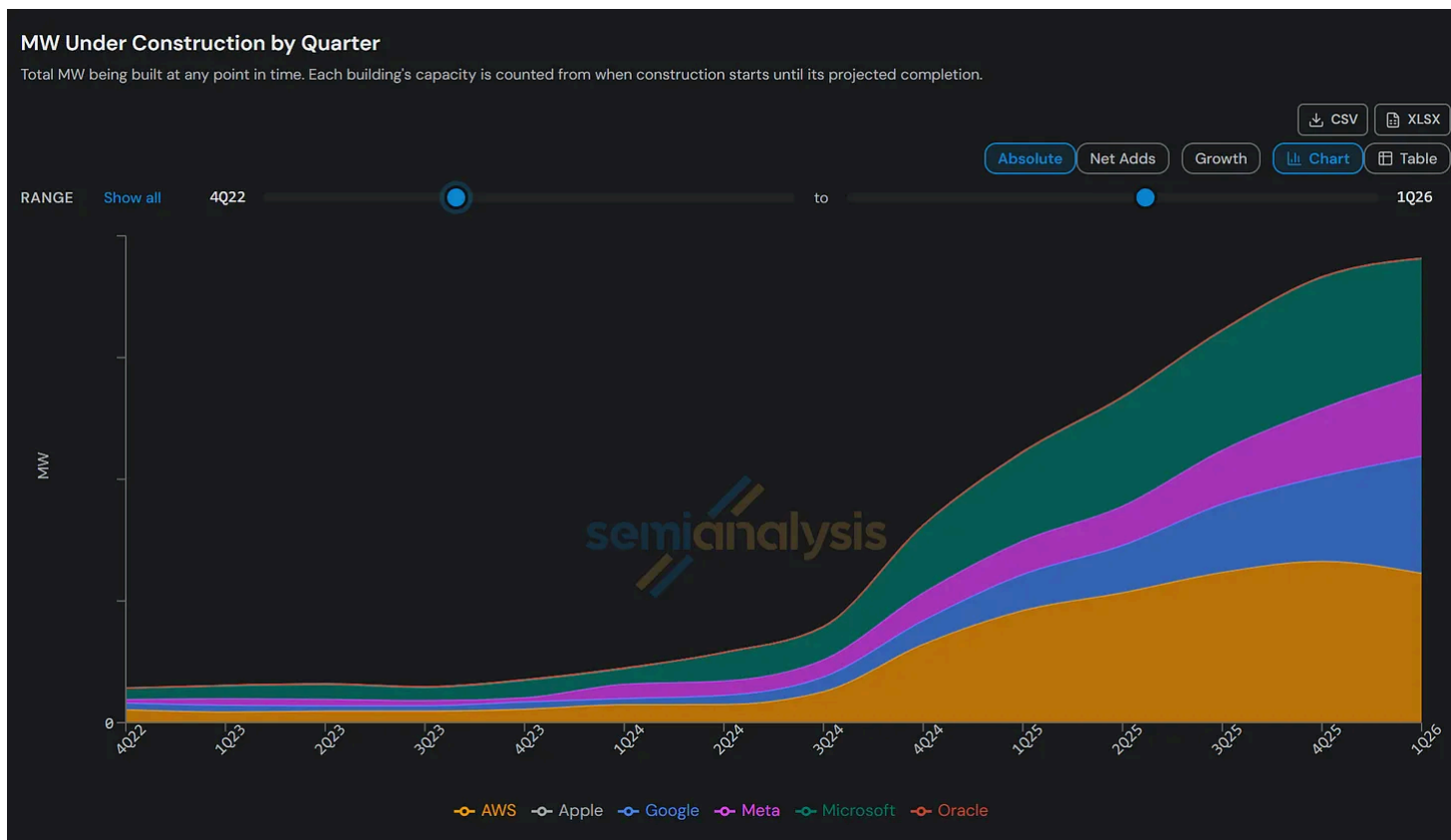
By Ellie Holbrook



There are two main reasons the headline narrative is wrong.

First, the headline number is built on a hugely flawed denominator, off by multiples. Bloomberg's data comes from Sightline Climate, which estimates that of the roughly 12 GW expected to come online in the US in 2026, only about 5 GW is currently under construction. Checking against our Vision Model, trained on hundreds of thousands of satellite images, even their Under Construction figures are off by multiples.

Taking ONLY the top-two hyperscalers alone gives us a higher Under Construction capacity than 5GW. And that's self-build only, it doesn't include the many GWs of capacity under construction by 3rd party developers.



Source: [SemiAnalysis Datacenter Industry Model](#)

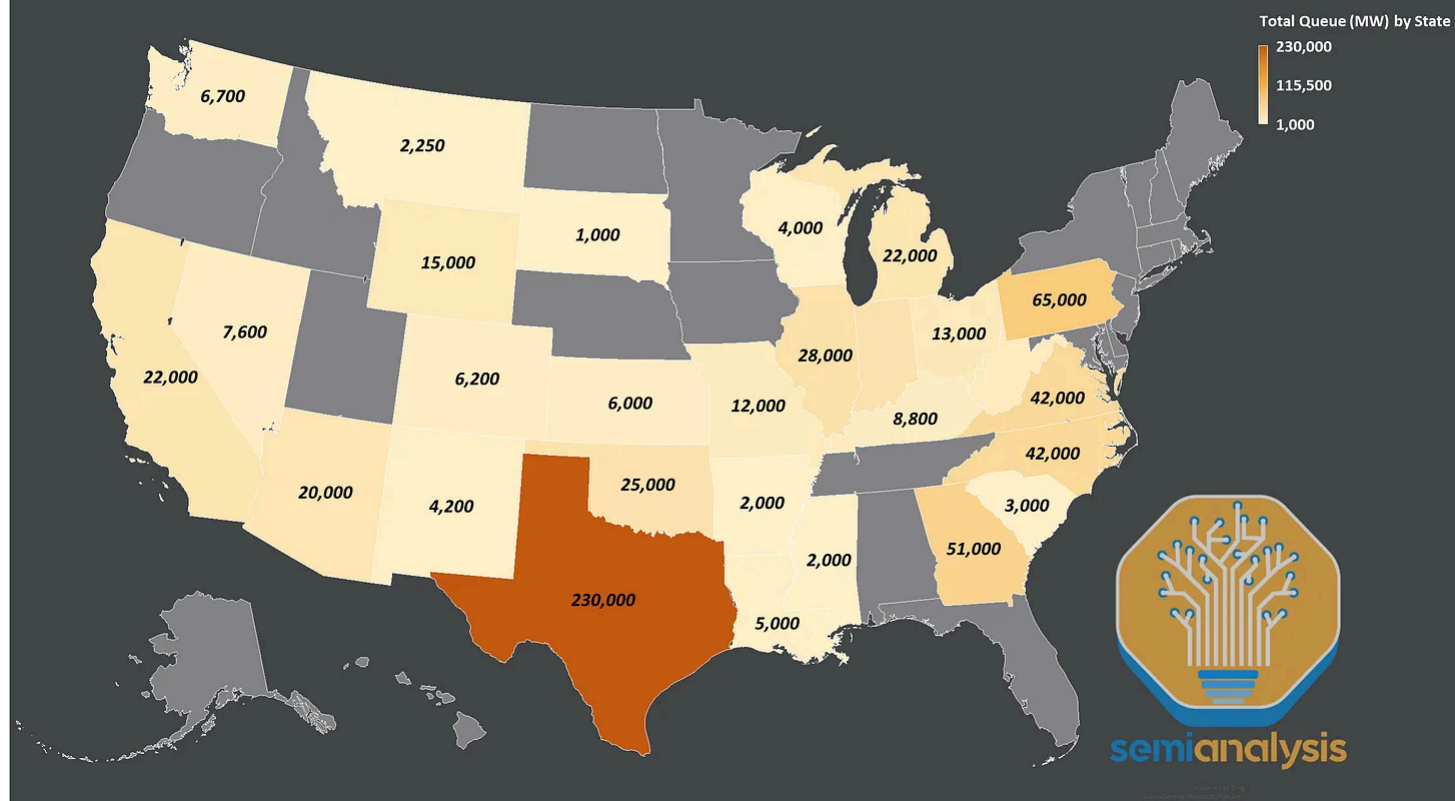
Sightline’s dataset clearly doesn’t track every datacenter under development; it likely tracks the large, publicly announced projects. That skews the basis heavily toward the kind of speculative megaprojects from inexperienced datacenter developers most likely to slip in the first place. The “50% cancelled or delayed” figure isn’t really a statement about the US datacenter pipeline, but rather about the slice of the pipeline most prone to slipping.

Second, even taking the Bloomberg/Sightline number at face value, almost all of what's getting flagged sits in the early-stage, or pre-construction "announced" bucket. These are speculative MW that weren't going to land on a 2026 timeline with any rigorous analysis. We've been writing for months that the market is in structural oversupply of early stage projects, with developers and landowners announcing projects on preliminary power estimates, often without financing, interconnection studies, or equipment orders in place.

Instead of falsely declaring them as 2026 projects, they rather show up in 2028+ in our model. In December 2025, we flagged that over half a Terawatt is in the large load queue in the US, and that number is now over a Terawatt. The vast majority are highly speculative, yet some developers make high profile announcements without much to show for. We do not put low probability datacenters in our datacenter timelines.

Large Load Requests in the US (GW)

Nearly a Terawatt of Datacenter Requests



Source: *SemiAnalysis Energy Model*

We will start by covering how common these questionable announcements are, and then display what real delays look like. We then cover the noise fueling the misled delay narrative, and close with why none of it has moved our numbers, for datacenters or for the equipment suppliers.

Let's Begin With Real Delays.

The Anatomy of a Datacenter Delay

We have three broad buckets to categorize datacenter delays, which we examine in depth below:

- Overly aggressive announcements by new players with speculative projects. The provided timelines are often simply unrealistic and should be discounted (which vibe-coded datacenter forecasts struggle with).
- Advanced projects but with too optimistic construction timelines, often carried by new datacenter developers who lack the experience. We dodge this via our extensive analysis of construction timelines. These developers typically don't account for traditional sources of delays, which are broad-based and can range from supplier late deliveries to weather-related issues to equipment issues, as well as many other construction and commissioning issues.
- Permitting and overall NIMBY (Not In My Backyard) issues slowing down an advanced project, forcing to change things like power sources or datacenter design.

1. Aggressive Announcements by Newer Datacenter Developers

New entrants in the space commonly try to give themselves some publicity by announcing massive GW-scale datacenters with aggressive timelines, despite their project being early stage. But it can take more than 4 years from land purchase to datacenter delivery. When we see a brand-new announcement in 2025 saying 2026 operational from a new “unknown” developer, it should raise some red flags. And for flagship multi-GW announcements, we often find that deeper analysis reveals these projects are very early, and sometimes don't even have long lead time equipment ordered. We are not denigrating these operators, but rather promoting caution on interpreting headline announcements correctly - which vibecoded forecasts often struggle with. Let's look at a few examples.

Data City, unveiled by Energy Abundance, boasted a 5GW campus, of which 300MW would launch in 2026. Looking again, the Energy Abundance website has very little except a “Contact Us” button. There has been no news since the announcement, and satellite imagery doesn’t show any evidence of physical progress. While AI-generated datacenter forecasts likely consider this as 2026 delayed capacity, any serious forecast would’ve taken this with some skepticism.

In June 2025, APR Energy announced a potential 400MW datacenter campus in Texas, where “The first phase of the project’s development is slated for early 2026.” At the same time, they were “currently seeking data center developers, hyperscalers, and AI partners to partner on the development of the facility.” No customer yet, a new developer, targeting a <1-year timeline needs to be approached with more scrutiny. There’s been no news since.

Another example is the Cloudburst facility in San Marcos, TX. It was announced as a 1.2GW facility, of which 50MW live by Q3 2026 (then pushed to Q4 2026). When announced in February 2025, that Q3 2026 timeline was unrealistic given many approvals weren’t secured yet. The company is now making good progress, and got the go-ahead by the local county in April 2026 for a >10B project - congrats to Cloudburst. They broke ground in November 2025 for that first 50MW phase, but the Q4 2026 timeline remains too aggressive based on real-time imagery, since shell construction hasn’t started yet. However, it’s easy to see how Claude Coded forecasts could get confused and assume 1.2GW is delayed. Some publicly available estimates out there claim that the site is planning to deliver 1.2GW by 2026 - which is not even consistent with the company’s own statements.

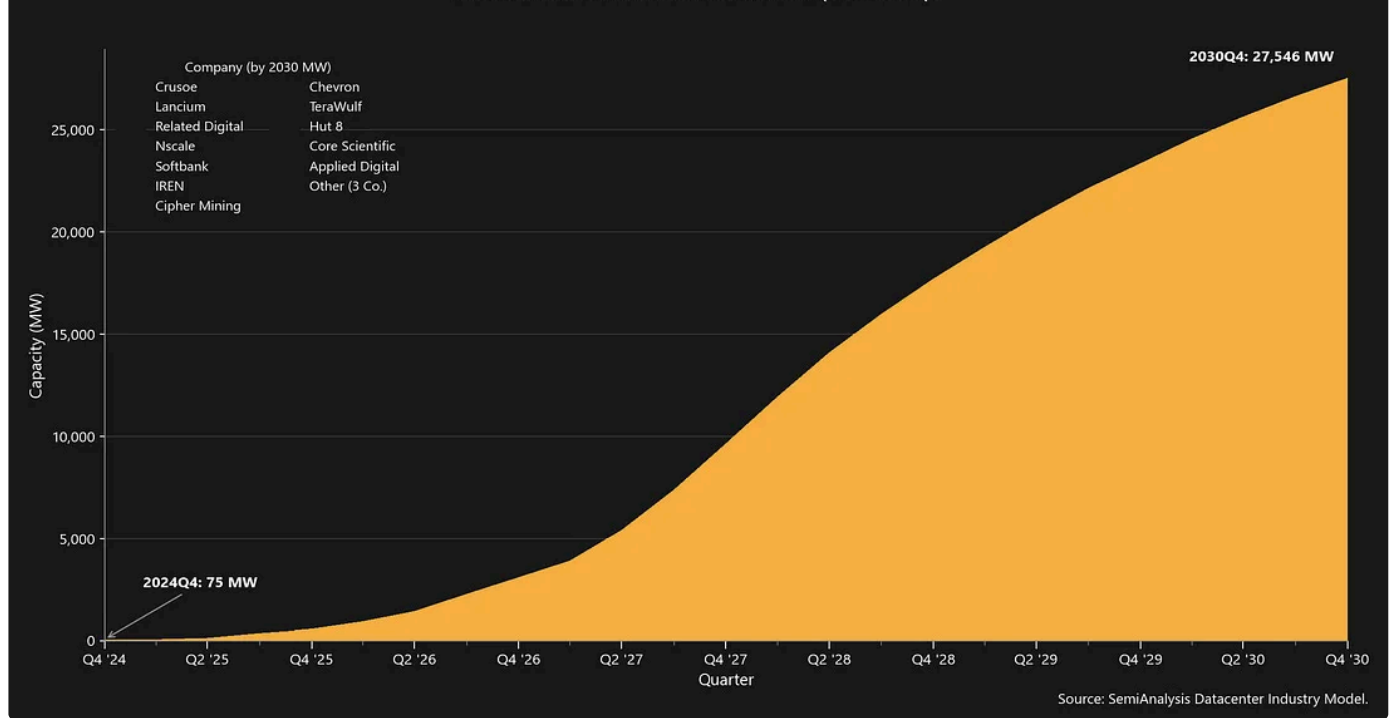
These are just a few examples of headlines, there are many more. If you look closely at the Claude Coded estimates, you will find many of these announcements are taken at face value. This is not a knock on the developers — as these projects may still be realized later - but an egregious error in many estimates’ methodology.

2. Advanced Projects With Overly Optimistic Construction Timelines

Many do not understand what it takes to construct a datacenter, and there’s plenty of new(er) operators with ambitious plans. Our forecast accuracy is the most reliable because we have refined our timelines extensively. We review every single type of datacenter design, both through local filings, and extensive satellite imagery. The vibecoded datacenter models have not learned what true timelines are, and instead mislead everyone.

Fifteen Newer AI DC Entrants Plan 28GW by 2030, Up From 75MW in 4Q2024

Combined Buildout Climbs 367x Between 2024Q4 and 2030Q4



Nebius' 300 MW New Jersey Flagship Datacenter

Nebius' flagship campus in New Jersey, built by developer DataOne, is a great example of the challenges of **constructing** a datacenter. In March 2025, DataOne was targeting a 4 month delivery for its first 50 MW phase despite the developer having no prior datacenter track record in the US. The schedule relied on precast materials and extensive prefabrication to compress the build. To be clear, we think this approach was highly innovative and we are big fans, but things are always more challenging than initially expected, especially for a new datacenter developer.

The first challenge arose in the equipment procurement. Per a LinkedIn post of an executive leading the development, late deliveries from a few suppliers pushed the first phase from 4 months to 6, i.e. a 2 month slip on its own.

Then, commissioning and installation proved longer than expected. Satellite imagery shows the shell going up remarkably fast, but setting up the MEP took far longer than the shell itself. In September 2025, the executive still claimed that he would imminently deliver the full facility. But our December 15th capture shows the chillers serving the second 25 MW still not in place, meaning the initial 50 MW building wasn't complete almost three months after delivery was declared imminent.